

QUACKED

Business Strategy & Go-To-Market

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PURPOSE

This is the business layer to Emma's product vision. It defines who Quacked is for, how large that market is, how the product makes money, and what guardrails keep the business focused and lean. Every go-to-market decision gets measured against what's in here.

MBB candidates who lack institutional prep support will pay for a tool that builds the one thing no casebook delivers: quant automaticity under pressure.

What Makes This Work

Founder credibility	Emma lived the problem, placed at McKinsey, and is building the tool that should have existed. That story is the pitch.
Built-in distribution	VP of Women in Consulting + Atlas board = direct access to the exact SAM before a dollar is spent on acquisition.
Seasonal urgency	Sophomore spring (Jan–Apr) is peak MBB recruiting — first rounds, second rounds, offers. Sophomores prepping for the most important internship of their undergrad career will pay for a tool that works.
No direct competitor	Casebooks are static. AI tools simulate full cases. Nobody does targeted, timed quant reps in a real business context.
Lean build	One-person build on Base44 + Supabase. No team, no payroll, no runway pressure. Profitable from the first paying user.

Five Things That Must Be True to Win

- The product is in sophomores' hands before spring recruiting starts in January — habit formation needs the fall semester
- The first beta cohort (from Emma's network) has a genuinely good experience before any broad launch
- The math is always right — one wrong answer destroys user trust permanently
- Retention is proven before acquisition scales — a leaky bucket does not compound
- One real outcome story from a candidate who advanced after using Quacked becomes the marketing anchor

The Problem & The Solution

The Problem

MBB candidates spend hundreds of hours on case prep. Most of it goes to frameworks, communication, and full-length cases. But when candidates receive feedback after first-round rejections, the most common note is not about structure — it is about quantitative confidence.

- Freezing when numbers get messy or ambiguous
- Slow setup — spending too long deciding which formula to use
- Arithmetic errors under pressure that unravel an otherwise strong case
- No intuition for whether an answer is directionally right

THE GAP

No existing prep tool targets this problem directly. Casebooks are long-form. Case coaches focus on communication. AI tools simulate full interviews. Nobody is doing targeted, repetitive, timed quant reps in a business context.

The Solution

Quacked delivers short, addictive, MBB-authentic math drills — configurable by firm, archetype, and difficulty — that build the one thing no casebook can: automaticity.

AUTOMATICITY

The ability to execute a skill without conscious effort. It's what separates a candidate who 'knows how to do profitability cases' from one who sets up the framework in 15 seconds and moves straight to insight.

The Outcome Promise

A candidate who drills 20 minutes a day on Quacked for 3 weeks will:

- Set up MBB quant problems faster and more consistently
- Stop second-guessing their math approach mid-case
- Build firm-specific intuition for realistic number ranges
- Arrive at interviews with genuine confidence in the quant, not just familiarity

What Quacked Is Not

What It Is NOT

Why It's Out of Scope

Full case interview simulator	Full cases require synthesis, communication coaching, and exhibit reading. Different product.
Casebook or PDF resource	Static content does not build automaticity. Repetition with randomization does.
Frameworks or strategy prep	MECE structures, hypothesis trees, communication coaching are out of scope. Quacked owns quant only.
Basic arithmetic trainer	Multiplication tables exist elsewhere. Quacked's edge is business-context-embedded math.
Live interview simulator	Real-time AI interviewer with voice and follow-ups is a future product, not MVP.
Community or social platform	Leaderboards and peer comparison are future features. MVP is single-player.

Who This Is For

Primary User — The Solo Preparer

The candidate preparing for MBB recruiting without institutional support. In practice, this is a college sophomore — spring semester, first rounds approaching, drilling daily to build quant confidence before the most consequential internship recruiting process of their undergraduate career.

- Sophomores at non-target or semi-target schools without a consulting club or peer prep network
- Sophomores at target schools whose club is oversubscribed, inaccessible, or not focused on quant
- Sophomores who attended fall discovery days and firm showcases and now need to get sharp fast before spring recruiting
- Re-recruiters who missed sophomore spring and are preparing for a second attempt

DEFINING CHARACTERISTIC
The primary user is not defined by school prestige — it is defined by structural isolation. They know the game. They have no one to play it with them. Quacked is built for them first.

Secondary User — The Club Adopter

Consulting clubs, pre-professional orgs, and bootcamps that adopt Quacked as a group drill tool. This is the distribution lever and the legitimacy signal.

- Women in Consulting chapters — direct access through Emma’s VP role, first activation target
- Atlas Business Society and peer orgs at UGA and peer institutions
- Consulting prep bootcamps and pre-MBA programs seeking scalable group drill tools
- Case prep partners who drill together and want a shared speed benchmark

WHY CLUBS MATTER
When Women in Consulting recommends Quacked, it carries implicit endorsement from an institution MBB recruiters respect. One club adoption is worth more than any paid ad.

Persona Comparison

Attribute	Primary — Solo Preparer	Secondary — Club Adopter
Who they are	Sophomore prepping for spring MBB internship recruiting	Consulting club VP, bootcamp director, org president
Prep stage	Soph fall (discovery days) → soph spring (first rounds, peak recruiting)	Semester-long, cohort-based prep program
Core pain	No quant reps, no benchmarks, no structure	No scalable group drill with benchmarks
Motivation	Confidence and speed before first round	Club credibility, member outcome tracking

Buys	Self — individual purchase decision	VP or president approves group access
Converts on	First drill that works + an outcome story from a peer	Peer club adoption + free trial for org

TAM / SAM / SOM

TAM — TOTAL ADDRESSABLE ~430K US undergrads and MBA students actively recruiting for consulting annually. Primary cohort: college sophomores recruiting for MBB summer internships. ~\$6.5B ceiling at \$15/mo.	SAM — SERVICEABLE 60–80K Serious MBB-targeting candidates. Avg prep spend \$200–\$800/cycle. SAM revenue potential ~\$120–160M.	SOM — OBTAINABLE YR 1 2–5K Paid users reachable through Emma’s network. Core cohort: current sophomores heading into spring recruiting. At \$15/mo with 60-day retention: ~\$180K–\$450K ARR.
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FRAMING

The TAM is the ceiling, not the plan. Quacked does not need 1% of the consulting prep market to build a real, profitable business. Nail the SOM. The SAM opens from there.

Why the SOM Is Real

- Emma’s direct network spans Women in Consulting, Atlas, UGA, and the broader MBB prep community — a warm addressable base of several thousand already
- The primary paying cohort is identifiable and concentrated: current sophomores with 8–12 weeks until spring first rounds — maximum urgency, maximum willingness to pay
- Sophomore fall is the acquisition window — students attending discovery days and firm showcases are actively looking for prep resources and forming habits before spring recruiting peaks
- A 21-day structured challenge format timed to January spring recruiting start has high virality potential in this cohort

Revenue Scenarios

Scenario	Paid Users	Avg Price	MRR	ARR
Conservative (launch month)	100	\$13/mo	\$1,300	\$15,600
Base (peak spring recruiting season)	500	\$14/mo	\$7,000	\$84,000
Target (Year 1)	2,000	\$14/mo	\$28,000	\$336,000
Stretch (Year 1 + clubs)	4K + 20 clubs	—	\$60,000+	\$720,000+

Revenue Model

Freemium with monthly subscription. The free tier creates habit. The paywall captures candidates the moment they feel it working.

PRICING ANCHOR

McKinsey provides candidates with an AI prep tool at first-round invitation. Quacked is the tool that gets them the invitation. That framing makes \$15/month an obvious buy — it's one coffee per week.

Free Tier — What It Includes

- 5 drills per day, one firm (user's choice)
- Tier 1 difficulty only — no progression without upgrading
- Basic speed feedback: correct/incorrect + time elapsed
- Final answer shown — no worked solution

The free tier is generous enough to feel real. Limited enough to create genuine upgrade motivation. The candidate who feels the product working will pay to unlock the rest.

Gate Model Options — Choose One Before Building

This decision determines the Supabase schema, drill access logic, and the free user's day-one experience. It cannot wait past the build phase.

MVP RECOMMENDATION

OPTION A

Volume Gate — 5 Drills / Day Free

Free users get 5 drills per day across one firm. Paid unlocks unlimited drills, all firms, all tiers.

PROS

- + Simple to understand and communicate
- + Creates daily habit loop before the paywall hits
- + User sees full product quality before deciding
- + Easiest to build and enforce for MVP

CONS

- Power users hit the wall fast — may churn instead of upgrade
- Casual users may never trigger the gate
- Doesn't gate on the highest-value features (worked solutions)

OPTION B

Feature Gate — Worked Solutions Behind Paywall

Unlimited free drills, but worked solutions, speed percentiles, and firm filtering are paid-only.

PROS

- + High-volume free usage drives organic word-of-mouth

- + Worked solution is the most valuable output — premium feels earned
- + Converts on insight, not just volume

CONS

- Users can use the product indefinitely without paying
- Harder to enforce server-side
- Lower urgency to upgrade for a casual user

OPTION C

Tier Gate — Earned Difficulty Behind Paywall

Free users stay at Tier 1 forever. Paid unlocks Tier 2+ progression. Pairs directly with XP system.

PROS

- + Perfectly aligned with P4 (earned difficulty)
- + Natural upgrade moment: 'You've mastered Tier 1 — unlock Tier 2'
- + Gamification drives retention and conversion simultaneously

CONS

- Requires XP thresholds fully defined before build
- Advanced users may not hit Tier 2 before their interview
- Slower time-to-paywall for high-skill candidates

Pricing Tiers

Free	Solo — RECOMMENDED	Grind	Club
\$0	\$12–15/mo	\$25–29/mo	\$99–149/mo
<i>Any candidate testing the product</i>	<i>Individual self-preparer — core paying user</i>	<i>Intensive recruiter, 4–8 weeks out</i>	<i>Orgs, clubs, bootcamps</i>
5 drills/day · 1 firm · Tier 1 only · Answer only	Unlimited drills · All firms · All tiers · Worked solutions · Speed percentiles	Everything in Solo · Priority content updates · Interview sim (future)	Group dashboard · Admin seat · Bulk member access · Usage analytics

LEAN PRINCIPLE

Build only the individual subscription for MVP. Club licensing is Phase 2, after 500 paying individual users. Each model requires a different sales motion. A solo builder cannot run two simultaneously.

Launch Strategy

Dominate UGA first. Prove the product works in one controlled market. Then expand with receipts.

THE CALENDAR IS THE STRATEGY

MBB undergraduate recruiting follows a two-stage annual cycle. Sophomore fall (Sept–Nov) is discovery — firm showcases, info sessions, early networking. This is when candidates start looking for prep resources and forming habits. Sophomore spring (Jan–Apr) is peak recruiting — first rounds, second rounds, offers for the internship the summer before senior year. Quacked must be a daily habit before January. Launch in September to catch the fall discovery window. Miss it and spring conversions suffer.

The UGA-First Strategy

Facebook started at Harvard. Tinder started at USC. DoorDash started at Stanford. Campus domination before national expansion is not a limitation — it is the playbook. Emma’s position at UGA makes this the obvious and correct first move.

WHY UGA FIRST

Emma is VP of Women in Consulting and on the Atlas executive board. That is direct, trusted access to virtually every sophomore at UGA considering consulting — before spending a dollar on acquisition. UGA Terry College is a legitimate MBB semi-target. The outcome stories will be real and credible. And when a UGA sophomore gets a McKinsey internship after drilling on Quacked, that story travels to their friends at Vanderbilt, Ole Miss, Georgia Tech, and beyond.

The goal of the UGA phase is not just users — it is proof. Proof that sophomores retain. Proof that quant drilling builds confidence. Proof that candidates who use Quacked advance in recruiting. That proof is what unlocks every campus after UGA.

One framing guardrail: position Quacked as ‘built at UGA, proven everywhere’ from day one — not as a campus tool. The product is national. The launch market is UGA.

Campus Expansion Roadmap

Stage	Market	Target Schools	Unlock Condition
Stage 1	Dominate UGA	University of Georgia	Launch. D7 retention > 40%. At least 3 outcome stories from spring recruiting.
Stage 2	SEC + peer semi-targets	Vanderbilt, Ole Miss, Auburn, Alabama, Georgia Tech, Wake Forest, UNC	UGA outcome stories published. One consulting club ambassador at each school. Network referrals from UGA alumni.
Stage 3	Broad semi-target network	Any school with an active consulting club and MBB placement history	500+ paying users. Club licensing model validated. Referral mechanic live.

Stage 4	Target schools	Wharton, Harvard, Kellogg, Booth, Columbia, Ross, Tuck, Duke	Product reputation precedes outreach. Organic inbound from semi-target word-of-mouth.
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THE KEY INSIGHT

The expansion from UGA to target schools is not a sales motion — it is a credibility motion. A sophomore at Wharton does not need to be sold on Quacked. They need to hear from a sophomore at UGA who got a Bain offer. Build the proof first. The distribution follows.

The MBB Undergraduate Recruiting Calendar

Stage	When	What This Means for Quacked
Sophomore Fall — ACQUISITION	Sept–Nov	Discovery days, firm showcases, info sessions. Sophomores are actively looking for prep resources and forming habits. This is the window to acquire them. Get Quacked in their hands now so drilling is routine before spring.
Winter Break Prep	Dec–Jan	High-urgency independent prep period. Sophomores know first rounds are weeks away. Daily drill streaks peak here. This is when free users convert to paid.
Sophomore Spring — MAIN EVENT	Jan–Apr	Peak recruiting. First rounds, second rounds, offers for junior summer internship. Quacked must already be a daily habit. Acquisition is late — focus is retention and speed confidence before each round.
Post-Recruiting	Apr–May	Outcome capture. Who got offers? Who advanced? Collect stories now. These become the September marketing asset for the next sophomore cohort.
Next Cohort — Flywheel	Sept (next year)	New sophomore class starts fall discovery. Outcome stories from last spring's cohort are live social proof. The annual cycle repeats with compounding credibility.

Three-Phase Launch Plan

PHASE 1
Now → August

Build at UGA Before They Need You

- Seed 30–60 beta users exclusively from UGA — Women in Consulting members, Atlas members, Terry consulting-track sophomores
- Run 2–3 in-person 'quant sprint' sessions on campus — use the product together, collect feedback, build the first testimonials
- Get Women in Consulting at UGA and Atlas to formally endorse Quacked before September — this is the social proof that opens every door in fall
- Document one strong outcome story before spring: a UGA sophomore who drilled and advanced in MBB recruiting
- Offer Club tier free to UGA Women in Consulting and Atlas in exchange for member list access and a co-branded launch post

PHASE 2
September → December

Own UGA Sophomore Fall Discovery Season

- Launch publicly the first week of September — UGA sophomores are at firm showcases and info sessions right now
- Emma posts LinkedIn launch content rooted in the founding story — UGA network amplifies it organically
- Women in Consulting and Atlas push Quacked to all sophomore members starting fall recruiting prep — warm, trusted endorsement
- Run a UGA-branded ‘21-Day Quant Challenge’ in October: daily drill, leaderboard, group accountability — high retention format
- Free-to-paid conversion push in December: UGA sophomores know spring is weeks away, urgency is maximum
- Begin soft outreach to Stage 2 schools (Vanderbilt, Georgia Tech) — not acquisition yet, just relationship building with club leaders

PHASE 3
January → April

Prove It at UGA. Expand With Receipts.

- Spring is the main event — track D7 and D14 retention daily for UGA users, this is the core product thesis being tested
- Referral mechanic live: ‘Invite a UGA prep partner — both get 7 days free’ — word-of-mouth travels fast in a single campus cohort
- Collect UGA outcome stories in real time: who got first rounds, who advanced, who placed — follow up by email within 48 hours of offer news
- If D7 retention > 40% and 3+ UGA outcome stories confirmed: activate Stage 2 expansion to Vanderbilt, Georgia Tech, and Ole Miss
- Publish UGA outcome stories in April — this is the marketing asset that seeds the next freshman and sophomore cohort in September

Channel Priority

Channel	Stage	Expected Yield	Cost
UGA WiC + Atlas (direct)	Pre-launch	Very high — warm, trusted, exact target user	\$0
UGA Terry in-person events	Phase 1–2	High — face-to-face trust, campus word-of-mouth	\$0
UGA outcome stories (LinkedIn + social)	Post-spring	Very high — peer proof travels to other schools	\$0
Stage 2 club newsletters (Vandy, GT, Ole Miss)	Phase 3 unlock	High — activated only after UGA proof exists	\$0 (relationship-based)
Emma LinkedIn founder content	Ongoing	Medium — builds national credibility beyond UGA	Time only
Referral mechanic	Phase 3	Medium — especially potent within one campus cohort	7 days free per pair
Paid acquisition	Post Stage 2 proof	TBD — not before D7 > 40% and multi-campus traction	Budget TBD

Five Rules

Every business, pricing, and GTM decision gets measured against these before moving forward. They mirror the format of Emma's product guardrails.

B1

Retention Before Acquisition

A leaky bucket does not scale. Do not spend money, time, or energy driving new users until existing users are coming back. A product that retains converts. A product that doesn't retain is a broken hypothesis — not a marketing problem.

GUARDRAIL: *No paid acquisition, influencer deals, or broad campaigns until D7 retention exceeds 40%.*

B2

The Network Is the Moat — Protect It

Emma's position in Women in Consulting and Atlas is the single most valuable distribution asset Quacked has. A bad product experience in those networks doesn't just lose a user — it loses the channel. Every beta user from these communities is a long-term relationship, not a test subject.

GUARDRAIL: *Do not soft-launch to community networks until the product is genuinely ready. One bad cohort experience in Women in Consulting closes that channel permanently.*

B3

One Revenue Model Until It Works

Do not build B2B club sales, affiliate programs, or coaching add-ons before the core subscription is validated. Each model requires a different sales motion, different infrastructure, and different support. A solo builder cannot run two business models simultaneously without compromising both.

GUARDRAIL: *MVP monetization is individual subscription only. Club licensing is Phase 2, after 500 paying individual users.*

B4

Seasonality Is the Product Calendar

MBB undergraduate recruiting follows a defined two-stage annual cycle. Sophomore fall (Sept–Nov) is discovery — firm showcases, info sessions, early prep habit formation. This is the acquisition window. Sophomore spring (Jan–Apr) is peak recruiting — first rounds, second rounds, offers for the internship the summer before senior year. This is the retention and conversion window. Every build, pricing, and GTM decision must be timed to these two stages.

GUARDRAIL: *Launch by September 1 to catch sophomores in fall discovery mode. Habit formation must happen before spring urgency peaks. Missing September means weaker spring conversion and waiting a full year for the next cohort.*

B6

Dominate One Campus Before Expanding to the Next

The temptation after a good launch will be to immediately push to other schools. Resist it. Expanding before UGA is proven dilutes focus, splits Emma's attention, and risks taking a half-baked product into networks where she has less trust and fewer second chances. The UGA proof is the expansion asset. Without it, every other campus is a cold pitch.

GUARDRAIL: *Do not activate Stage 2 expansion (Vanderbilt, Georgia Tech, Ole Miss) until UGA hits D7 retention > 40% and produces at least 3 published outcome stories from spring recruiting.*

B5

Outcome Stories Are the Marketing Strategy

No ad budget will outperform a sophomore posting 'I used Quacked every day for 8 weeks and got my McKinsey internship offer.' Every early user who places in spring recruiting is a case study. The system to collect these outcomes must be built into the product at launch — not added later.

GUARDRAIL: *Build a lightweight outcome-collection flow into the product before launch. Ask users if they advanced. Store the answer. This data is the marketing asset.*

Resolve Before You Build

These are the questions that cannot be deferred past the build phase. Each one forces a product or infrastructure decision. Answer them in order of urgency.

WHY THIS LIST EXISTS

Ambiguity at this stage doesn't stay ambiguous — it becomes a wrong build decision baked into the database. Answer these before Supabase tables are finalized and before a single prompt is shipped.

#	Decision & Why It Can't Wait	Urgency
01	What are the 10 archetypes, named? Everything — math engine, edge functions, prompt design, QA, and content seeding — depends on this list. This is the product backbone. Nothing else can be fully built without it.	RESOLVE NOW
02	Which gate model — A, B, or C? Determines the Supabase schema, drill access logic, and what a free user sees on day one. The database must know the gate before the first table is created.	RESOLVE NOW
03	What are the XP thresholds per tier? The earned-difficulty system (P4) cannot be built or tested without defined thresholds. Required before the gate model can be properly evaluated.	RESOLVE NOW
04	What are the exact price points? Must be entered in Stripe before any paid user can convert — even in private beta. Also affects whether the Grind tier is worth the complexity.	RESOLVE NOW
05	How is outcome data collected from users? If not built into MVP, it won't get added post-launch. This is the marketing asset. One field, one trigger, one email. Design it in now.	BEFORE LAUNCH
06	Is club licensing built before or after 500 paying users? Determines whether the DB needs org/group tables before MVP. Recommendation is after — but this must be a conscious decision, not a deferred one.	BEFORE LAUNCH



The Business North Star

Quacked exists for every candidate preparing for MBB recruitment without a consulting club, a coach, or a structured program. The quant confidence that determines first and final-round outcomes should not depend on who you know or where you study.

Every decision — pricing, feature, partnership, channel — gets one question:

Does this help a candidate preparing alone get better, faster?

If yes — build it. If not — it waits.
